

TOOLBOX

1. Passage anchor

> “In a way, her mind felt like a well-organised **toolbox**: whenever a student got stuck, she seemed to pull out exactly the right explanation.”

Passage meaning

toolbox = figuratively, a collection of useful methods, skills, ideas, or strategies that can be used when needed

工具箱；一套可隨時運用的方法 / 策略 / 技巧

Here, Ms. Lau’s mind is compared to a **well-organised toolbox** because she seems to have many different explanations and teaching strategies available, and she can choose the right one for each situation.

Practice

1. Every good teacher needs a **toolbox of strategies** for helping different learners.

每位好老師都需要一套能幫助不同學習者的**策略工具箱**。

2. Experience gradually gives you a larger mental **toolbox**.

經驗會逐漸讓你擁有更豐富的**思考工具與方法**。

Core meanings of TOOLBOX

2. toolbox — box for storing tools

= a box or container used to store and carry tools

工具箱

Examples

1. He keeps his hammer and screwdrivers in a **toolbox**.

他把鎚子和螺絲起子放在**工具箱**裡。

2. She carried the **toolbox** into the garage.

她把**工具箱**拿進車庫。

This is the central literal meaning.

3. portable toolbox

= a toolbox designed to be carried from place to place

****便攜式工具箱****

Examples

1. The technician brought a small ****portable toolbox****.
技術人員帶了一個小型****便攜式工具箱****。

2. A ****portable toolbox**** is useful for repair work.
****便攜式工具箱****很適合維修工作。

Figurative set of methods / skills

4. toolbox — collection of useful methods or strategies

= a set of techniques, ideas, approaches, or resources available for solving problems

****一套工具；方法庫；策略工具箱****

This is the exact passage branch.

Examples

1. Teachers need a broad ****toolbox of methods****.
老師需要一套廣泛的****教學方法工具箱****。

2. Good communication adds another skill to your ****toolbox****.
良好的溝通又為你的****技能庫****增加了一項工具。

5. mental toolbox

= collection of thinking strategies, knowledge, and problem-solving methods in someone's mind

****思考工具箱；腦中的方法庫****

Examples

1. Reading widely expands your ****mental toolbox****.
廣泛閱讀能擴充你的****思考工具箱****。

2. She had a rich ****mental toolbox**** for explaining difficult concepts.
她腦中有一套很豐富的****解釋方法庫****，能處理困難概念。

Very close to the passage metaphor.

6. teaching toolbox

= collection of techniques and resources a teacher can use

****教學工具箱；教學策略庫****

Examples

1. Group work is one useful tool in a teacher's ****teaching toolbox****.
小組活動是老師****教學工具箱****中的一種實用方法。
2. Experienced teachers usually develop a wider ****teaching toolbox****.
有經驗的老師通常會建立更完整的****教學策略庫****。

Professional / practical metaphor

7. toolbox — professional set of skills

= practical range of abilities someone can draw on in their work

****技能庫；專業工具組****

Examples

1. Negotiation is an important skill in a manager's ****toolbox****.
談判是主管****技能庫****中的一項重要能力。
2. Data analysis should be part of a researcher's ****toolbox****.
資料分析應該是研究人員****專業工具組****的一部分。

8. add something to your toolbox

= learn or acquire another useful method, skill, or resource

****把某項技能 / 方法加入自己的工具庫****

Examples

1. Learning to ask better questions adds another technique to your ****toolbox****.
學會提出更好的問題，就是把另一種技巧加入自己的****方法庫****。

2. Public speaking is a useful skill to add to your professional **toolbox**.
公開演講是一項值得加入專業**技能庫**的實用能力。

Software / interface

9. toolbox — panel or collection of software tools

= set of tools or commands available in a software interface

工具箱；**工具面板**

Examples

1. Select the shape tool from the **toolbox**.
從**工具箱 / 工具面板**中選擇形狀工具。
2. The drawing program has a **toolbox** on the left side of the screen.
這個繪圖程式在畫面左側有一個**工具面板**。

Established computing/design use.

10. software toolbox

= collection of software functions, modules, or utilities designed for a particular task

軟體工具箱；**工具套件**

Examples

1. The program includes a statistical **toolbox**.
這套程式包含一個統計**工具箱**。
2. Engineers used a simulation **toolbox** to test the model.
工程師使用模擬**工具套件**測試模型。

Programming / technical packages

11. toolbox — technical collection of functions or modules

= organized set of specialized tools for analysis, programming, engineering, etc.

工具套件；**函式工具箱**

Examples

1. The software provides an image-processing **toolbox**.
這套軟體提供影像處理**工具套件**。
2. Researchers used a machine-learning **toolbox**.
研究人員使用了一套機器學習**工具箱**。

This remains metaphorically related to the literal box of tools.

Policy / management metaphor

12. policy toolbox

= set of policy measures available to decision-makers
政策工具箱；政策手段

Examples

1. Governments have several tools in the **policy toolbox**.
政府在**政策工具箱**中有多種手段可以使用。
2. Regulation is only one part of the **policy toolbox**.
監管只是**政策工具箱**中的一種工具。

Formal figurative usage.

13. management toolbox

= collection of techniques available to managers
管理工具箱；管理方法庫

Examples

1. Feedback is one tool in a manager's **toolbox**.
回饋是主管**管理工具箱**中的一項工具。
2. Coaching belongs in every leader's **management toolbox**.
教練式指導應該是每位領導者**管理方法庫**的一部分。

Related forms

14. tool

A. physical instrument

****工具****

1. A hammer is a useful ****tool****.

鎚子是一種實用的****工具****。

B. method or resource

****手段；方法；工具****

2. Questions are powerful teaching ****tools****.

提問是很有力的教學****工具****。

The figurative meaning of ****toolbox**** develops directly from this second sense of ****tool****.

15. toolkit

= set of tools, methods, or resources used for a task

****工具組；工具包；方法套件****

Examples

1. The guide provides a practical ****toolkit**** for teachers.

這份指南為老師提供了一套實用****工具包****。

2. Communication skills are part of a leader's ****toolkit****.

溝通技巧是領導者****能力工具組****的一部分。

****Toolkit**** overlaps strongly with figurative ****toolbox****.

High-value expressions

16. have something in your toolbox

= have a useful skill, strategy, or method available

****具備某項可運用的方法 / 技能****

Examples

1. It helps to have several explanation styles in your ****toolbox****.
擁有幾種不同解釋方式作為自己的****方法庫****會很有幫助。
2. Patience is an important tool to have in your teaching ****toolbox****.
耐心是教學****工具箱****中很重要的一項工具。

17. pull something out of your toolbox

= choose and use a suitable method or strategy

****從自己的方法庫中挑出合適方法****

This is the metaphor used in the passage.

Examples

1. When students were confused, she could ****pull another strategy out of her toolbox****.
學生困惑時，她可以****從自己的策略庫中換另一種方法****。
2. Experienced speakers know which technique to ****pull out of the toolbox****.
有經驗的講者知道該****拿出哪一種技巧來用****。

18. expand your toolbox

= gain more methods, skills, or resources

****擴充自己的技能 / 方法庫****

Examples

1. Training can help teachers ****expand their toolbox****.
培訓可以幫助老師****擴充自己的教學方法庫****。
2. Working with different people ****expanded my toolbox****.
和不同的人合作****擴充了我的技能庫****。

Countability

19. toolbox is countable

- * a toolbox
- * one toolbox
- * several toolboxes

Examples

1. He bought a new **toolbox**.
他買了一個新的**工具箱**。
2. Different professions require different **toolboxes**.
不同專業需要不同的**工具組 / 方法庫**。

Plural figurative **toolboxes** is possible, though singular metaphorical use is especially common.

Key contrasts

20. toolbox vs toolkit

toolbox

= literally a box holding tools; figuratively a collection of methods or skills

工具箱 ; 方法庫

toolkit

= collection of tools/resources, often packaged for a particular purpose

工具組 ; 工具包

Compare:

> a mechanic's **toolbox**

> 機械師的工具箱

> a teacher-training **toolkit**

> 教師培訓工具包

In figurative professional usage, they overlap heavily.

21. toolbox vs skill set

skill set

= group of skills a person possesses

技能組合

****toolbox****

= broader; can include:

- * skills
- * strategies
- * techniques
- * resources
- * frameworks

Compare:

> She has a strong ****skill set****.

> 她具備很強的一套技能。

> She has a broad teaching ****toolbox****.

> 她有很豐富的教學方法和策略。

22. toolbox vs repertoire

****repertoire****

= range of skills, techniques, pieces, or behaviors someone can perform or use

****技能庫；招數；可運用範圍****

****toolbox****

= emphasizes practical usefulness for solving problems

Compare:

> a teacher's ****repertoire of techniques****

> 老師可運用的各種技巧

> a teacher's ****toolbox of strategies****

> 老師解決問題用的策略工具庫

23. toolbox vs resource

****resource****

= individual source of help or useful material

****資源****

****toolbox****

= collection of several resources/tools

A worksheet can be a resource; a whole set of worksheets, techniques, and strategies may form part of a toolbox.

24. toolbox vs knowledge

****knowledge****

= what someone knows

****知識****

****toolbox****

= what someone can actively draw on and use

This distinction matters in the passage:

Ms. Lau does not merely possess knowledge; she has many usable ways to explain and solve problems.

Meaning map

The central literal meaning of ****toolbox**** is:

****a container holding useful tools****

From this develops a very productive metaphor:

Literal

toolbox

→ ****裝工具的箱子****

Mental

mental toolbox

→ ****可隨時使用的思考方法****

Teaching

teaching toolbox

→ ****教學策略庫****

Professional

professional toolbox

→ **技能與方法庫**

Software

software toolbox

→ **工具面板 / 工具套件**

Policy

policy toolbox

→ **可供選擇的政策手段**

The underlying metaphor is:

physical tools help you solve practical problems

→ therefore:

skills, strategies, and ideas are mental/professional “tools”

→ and a **toolbox** is the collection that holds them.

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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toolbox — literal	用來存放、整理和攜帶工具的箱子；工具箱
toolbox — methods/strategies	可在不同情況下使用的一套方法、技巧或策略；方法庫 / 策略工具箱
mental toolbox	一個人腦中可用來思考、解決問題和理解事物的方法與知識庫
teaching toolbox	老師可用於解釋、教學、管理和支援學生的一套教學策略
professional toolbox	某專業人士可實際運用的技能、技巧與方法集合
add something to your toolbox	學到並納入一項新的實用技能、方法或策略
toolbox — software interface	軟體中集中放置不同功能或工具的工具面板 / 工具箱
software/technical toolbox	為特定技術工作提供的一套函式、模組或工具；工具套件
policy toolbox	政策制定者可選用的一系列政策手段
management toolbox	主管可使用的管理技巧、方法與策略集合

| **pull something out of your toolbox** | 從自己已有的方法中挑選一個適合當下情況的策略來使用
|
| **expand your toolbox** | 增加自己可運用的技能、方法或資源 |
| **toolkit** | 為特定目的整理的一組工具、資源或方法；工具包 |

Passage recap

> “...her mind felt like a well-organised **toolbox**: whenever a student got stuck, she seemed to pull out exactly the right explanation.”

Here:

toolbox = **a figurative collection of useful explanations, strategies, and problem-solving methods**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **工具箱** *

* **方法庫** *

* **策略工具箱** *

* contextually: **一套整理得很有條理、隨時可取用的思考與教學方法** *

Natural contextual translation:

某程度上，她的腦袋就像一個整理得井井有條的工具箱；每當學生卡住，她總能拿出最合適的解釋方式。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

toolbox

= **a collection of useful methods, skills, or strategies that someone can choose from when needed**

方法庫；策略工具箱；可運用的一套技能與方法

The metaphor is:

> physical **toolbox**

> → contains different tools for different jobs

and:

> mental **toolbox**

> → contains different explanations and strategies for different problems

That is exactly how the word works in this passage.